

Event Staff Platform — Complete UX Blueprint

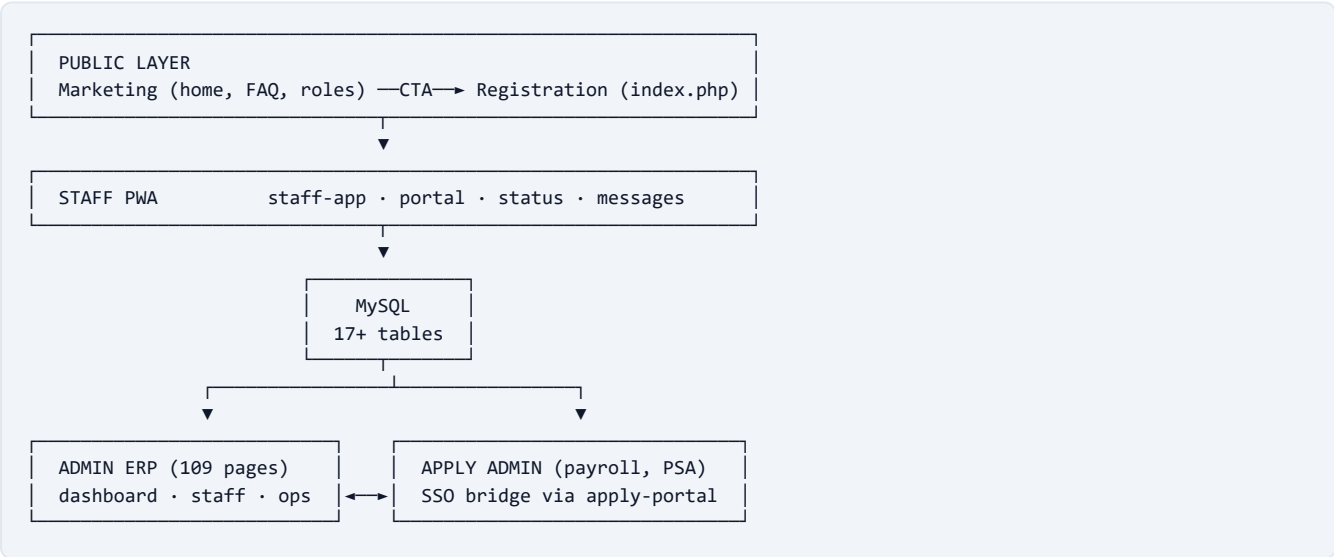
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1. Platform Topology

The system is a **workforce operations platform** with four surfaces sharing one data model:

Surface	Host	Primary users	Job to be done
Marketing site	Main domain	Prospective staff, clients	Trust, explain roles, drive registration
Registration site	register.*	New/returning applicants	Apply for shifts, submit PSA/bank details
Staff PWA	register.*	Approved/pending staff	Track status, check in, message ops, get alerts
Admin ERP	admin.*	Admin, Manager, Staff role	Run events: roster → attendance → finance
Apply admin	apply.*	Admin, payroll	PSA compliance, payroll export, master vault



2. Data Model → UX Domains

The database implies six product domains. UX should mirror these, not the current 22 flat sidebar links.

Domain	Core tables	Natural UX home
People	staff, staff_registrations, staff_blacklist	Staff Directory + Registration Queue
Events & venues	events, venues, work_types	Event Command Center
Field ops	attendance (+ work-hours columns)	Live Ops (check-in, hours)

Communications	staff_messages, app_notifications, push_subscriptions	Unified Inbox
Finance	commission_invoices, saved_job_records, personal_invoice_lines	Finance workspace
Platform	system_settings, admin_users, admin_audit_log, website_visits	Settings & governance

Key entity relationships

- `staff` = identity (one person, one email)
- `staff_registrations` = shift application (one row per email × event)
- `attendance` = check-in record (one per registration)
- `staff_messages` = threaded by `staff_id`, not registration
- `app_notifications` = dual audience (admin | staff), keyed by `staff_email` for staff

Design rule: Staff screens anchor on *person* (email/session). Admin screens support context switching between person view and event view.

3. Current State — Structural Gaps

Problem	Evidence	Impact
Flat admin nav	22 sidebar items; Finance hides 3 invoice sub-products	Cognitive overload
Split communications	Notifications + Messages separate nav + badges	Missed alerts, confused channels
Event ops scattered	Attendance, scan, hours, venues under Events	Event-day operators hunt across 6 pages
Settings sprawl	14 settings + go-live + backups + CMS under System	Admin tasks mixed with daily ops
Staff hub is tile grid	staff-app.php lists 6+ equal-weight tiles	No personalized "my next shift" view
Apply is a bridge	apply-portal.php SSO to another subdomain	Broken mental model
Invisible actions	~35 POST-only pages not in nav	Should be modals/drawers, not screens

4. Ideal Information Architecture

Admin ERP — 6 modules, 18 nav items max

```
OPERATIONS (default landing)
├─ Command Center    - role-adaptive dashboard
├─ Inbox             - messages + notifications unified
├─ Ops Checklist     - pre-event readiness
├─ Live Ops          - event-day: scan, attendance, roster

PEOPLE
├─ Registration Queue
├─ Staff Directory
├─ Compliance        - blacklist, PSA flags, incomplete profiles

EVENTS
├─ Event Calendar
├─ Event Detail      - single event hub (tabs, not nav item)
├─ Venues
├─ Work Types

FINANCE
├─ Client Invoicing  - commission invoices
├─ Job Records
├─ Personal Invoices
├─ Exports & Reports

CONTENT & GROWTH (admin only)
├─ Registration Forms
├─ Website CMS
├─ Visitor Analytics

SYSTEM (admin only)
├─ Settings          - tabbed: Site, Email, Integrations, Theme, Security
├─ Team & Access
├─ Go Live / Health
├─ Audit & Backups
```

Staff PWA — 3-tab shell

```
HOME      - My shifts, next event, quick status
INBOX     - Messages + notifications (single stream)
ACCOUNT   - Profile, PSA, bank, sign out
```

Hub tiles (staff-app.php) remain the **logged-out entry**; signed-in users land on Home.

Public website

```
DISCOVER  - Home, How it works, Roles, Events showcase
TRUST     - FAQ, Contact, Privacy
ACT       - Register (register subdomain)
RETURN    - Staff app / Sign in (footer CTA)
```

Registration funnel (single path)

Choose role/form → Select venue/events → Personal details → PSA/bank → Confirm → Status link

5. Navigation Hierarchy

Admin — role-based nav matrix

Nav item	Admin	Manager	Staff (venue)
Command Center	•	•	• simplified
Inbox	•	•	—
Live Ops	•	•	•
Registration Queue	•	•	—
Staff Directory	•	•	—
Events / Finance	•	•	—
Forms / CMS / System	•	—	—

Navigation patterns

Surface	Pattern	Use for
Admin	Persistent sidebar (280px / 80px rail)	Module switching
Admin	Context header bar	Event selector, date filter, staff search
Admin	Breadcrumbs	People → Directory → [Name] → Registration
Admin	Event-scoped sub-nav	Inside Event Detail: Overview · Roster · Attendance · QR
Staff PWA	Bottom tab bar	Home · Inbox · Account
Staff PWA	Deep links	status?token=, notification action_url, check-in QR
Public	Top nav + sticky CTA	Register for shifts

6. Dashboard Architecture (Command Center)

One route (`dashboard.php`), three role-adaptive layouts.

Layout zones (all roles)

GREETING + ROLE CONTEXT + PRIMARY CTA (one contextual)			
KPI 1	KPI 2	KPI 3	KPI 4
ATTENTION QUEUE (max 3 cards, prioritized)			
TIMELINE / UPCOMING		INBOX PREVIEW (5 items)	
QUICK ACTIONS (role-filtered, max 6)			

Administrator / Manager

Zone	Content
Primary CTA	"Review N pending" OR "Open Live Ops" on event day
KPIs	Pending · Approved today · Check-ins today · Unread inbox
Attention queue	① Pending ② Unread messages ③ Ops checklist ④ PSA expiring
Timeline	Next 5 events with approved/pending/checked-in counts
Inbox preview	Unified messages + system notifications

Staff role (venue operator)

Zone	Content
Primary CTA	Start scanning → <code>scan-checkin.php</code>
KPIs	Check-ins today · On-site now · Remaining approved
Attention queue	Event selector (today's events only)
Quick actions	Scan · Attendance log · Work hours

Dashboard rules

1. **One primary CTA** — never 4 competing buttons
2. **Attention queue is prioritized**, not a flat card grid
3. **Event-day mode** auto-surfaces Live Ops when event is within ± 2 hours
4. **Drill-down only** — dashboard never edits data inline

7. Notification Center Architecture

Ideal model: **one inbox, three delivery channels** (in-app, email, push).

Notification taxonomy

Type	Audience	Trigger	Primary action
registration_new	Admin	New submission	Registration detail
registration_status	Staff	Approve/reject	<code>status.php?token=</code>

event_activated	Staff	Event goes live	Register or status
profile_required	Staff	Incomplete profile	staff-profile.php
message_reply	Both	Thread activity	Message thread
ops_reminder	Admin	Daily cron	Ops checklist item
psa_expiry	Admin	Apply sync	Apply PSA compliance
checkin_confirm	Staff	Self check-in	Status page

Admin unified inbox

Inbox	[All Messages Alerts]	
• Sarah M – "Can I swap shift?"	2m	← message
• New registration – Nick Cave	14m	← alert
o Event activated – Metallica	1h	← read

- **Messages tab** = staff_messages threads (staff-inbox.php)
- **Alerts tab** = app_notifications where audience=admin
- **All** = merged timeline; messages rank above read alerts
- **Single sidebar badge** = unread messages + unread alerts

Staff unified inbox

One tab in PWA replacing separate notification and message tiles. Token-based access preserved for unsigned users.

Delivery rules

Channel	When
In-app	Always
Email	Configurable per type in Settings → Notifications
Push	Staff PWA only; opt-in via push_subscriptions

8. Public Website Architecture

Marketing site map

Screen	File	Purpose
Home	home.php	Hero, trust, CTA to register
How it works	how-it-works.php	Apply → approved → check in
Roles	roles.php	DSP / Static / Steward
Events	events.php	Showcase active events
FAQ	faq.php	Self-service support
Contact	contact.php	Company contact
Privacy	privacy.php	GDPR / consent

Registration host (register.*)

Screen	File	Purpose
Registration form	index.php	Multi-event, form-slug registration
Submit handler	submit.php	POST processor (not a screen)

Public UX principles

1. Marketing ≠ Registration — separate URLs
2. One hero CTA on every page: Register
3. Footer: "Already registered? Open staff app"
4. No admin chrome — shared public shell only

9. Staff PWA Architecture

App shell (signed in)

Header: logo · notification badge		
SCREEN CONTENT		
[Home]	[Inbox]	[Account]

Logged out hierarchy

```
staff-app.php (Hub)
├─ Register → index.php
├─ Staff sign-in → staff-portal.php → staff-profile.php (if incomplete)
├─ My status → status.php (lookup or ?token=)
├─ Messages → staff-messages.php
└─ Notifications → staff-notifications.php
```

Logged in hierarchy

```
HOME
├─ Next shift card (event, date, status)
└─ Quick actions: Status · Check-in info · Message
```

- └─ Active registrations list
 - └─ Announcement banner (staff_broadcast)
- INBOX
- └─ Unified feed (messages + notifications)
 - └─ Thread view
 - └─ Notification detail with CTA
- ACCOUNT
- └─ Profile summary (compact)
 - └─ Edit profile (?edit=1)
 - └─ PSA licence update
 - └─ Sign out

PWA feature priorities

Feature	Priority
Install prompt	Keep on hub
Service worker (shell cache)	Home + Inbox + status
Push notifications	Event activation, approval, message reply
Offline status view	Cache last-known status per token

10. Admin Screen Hierarchy (Complete)

Level 1 — Sidebar modules

OPERATIONS: Command Center · Inbox · Ops Checklist · Live Ops
PEOPLE: Registration Queue · Staff Directory · Compliance
EVENTS: Event Calendar · Venues · Work Types
FINANCE: Client Invoicing · Job Records · Personal Invoices · Exports
CONTENT: Forms · Website CMS (admin only)
SYSTEM: Settings · Team Users · Go Live · Audit (admin only)

Level 2 — Detail screens (not in nav)

Module	Screens
People	view-staff.php, staff-edit.php, staff-inbox-thread.php
Events	event-form.php, Event Detail hub, venue-form.php, attendance.php, scan-checkin.php, work-hours.php, print-roster.php
Finance	invoice-form.php, job-record-form.php, personal-invoice-form.php, print-invoice.php
Settings	settings-production.php, settings-email.php, settings-theme.php, settings-security.php, google-sheets-diagnostic.php, visitor-locations.php, geo-audits.php, backups.php

Level 3 — Actions (POST handlers → buttons/modals, never nav)

update-status.php, bulk-status.php, save-event.php, toggle-event.php, checkin-action.php, scan-checkin-action.php, ops-checklist-action.php, invoice-action.php, backup-run.php, user-action.php, and ~25 more.

11. Event Detail Hub (New Conceptual Screen)

Biggest IA win: one event command page instead of 8 disconnected links. Implemented as tabs over existing pages.

Event: Nick Cave — 10 Jun 2026

[Overview]	[Roster]	[Attendance]	[Hours]	[QR]	[Sheets]	
Status: Active · Venue: 3Arena · 36 approved / 1 pending						
Staff needed: 40 · Checked in: 0 · Sheet: [linked]						
[Activate] [Edit] [Print roster]						
ROSTER TAB → staff.php?event_id=X						
ATTENDANCE TAB → attendance.php?event_id=X						
HOURS TAB → work-hours.php?event_id=X						

12. Critical User Journeys

A — New staff registration

Marketing home → Register → index.php → submit.php
→ email → status.php?token= (pending)
→ [admin approves] → notification + email
→ status.php (approved) → staff-app.php → install PWA

B — Event day operations

Command Center → "Live Ops" CTA
→ scan-checkin.php → attendance.php (exceptions)

→ work-hours.php → export-attendance.php

C — Pre-event readiness

ops-checklist.php → pending_cleared → staff.php
→ apply_sync → apply-portal.php
→ psa_expiry → Apply PSA compliance
→ sheets_spot_check → google-sheets-diagnostic.php

D — Finance month-end

invoices.php → invoice-quick.php → print-invoice.php
→ job-records.php → export-invoices-month.php

13. Global Patterns

Pattern	Admin	Staff PWA
Global search	Staff name, email, event	N/A
Event filter	Persistent in People + Live Ops	"My events" on Home
Status chips	pending / approved / rejected	Same on status page
Empty states	Actionable CTA	"No shifts — register"
Broadcasts	Admin flash bar	staff_broadcast banner
Date format	Irish (DD/MM/YYYY)	Same

14. Design Principles

1. **Ops-first, finance-second** — Daily users live in Operations + People
2. **Event context is king** — Global event selector in admin header
3. **Mobile-native staff, desktop-native admin**
4. **One badge per channel** — Unified inbox badge only
5. **Progressive disclosure** — System/CMS hidden until needed
6. **Keep premium sidebar** — Regroup items into 6 modules, don't redesign chrome

15. Implementation Roadmap (UX)

Phase	Focus	Outcome
P1 — Nav regroup	Sidebar regroup + Finance sub-nav	Immediate clarity, no new routes
P2 — Unified Inbox	Merge admin notifications + messages	Single badge, single habit
P3 — Event Detail hub	Tab shell over existing event pages	Event-scoped ops
P4 — Staff Home	Replace tile grid for signed-in users	Personalized shift view
P5 — Command Center v2	Role-adaptive dashboard zones	Right CTA per role per day
P6 — Live Ops mode	Event-day fullscreen scan entry	Venue operator speed

Screen count summary (target state)

Surface	Current	Target primary	Change
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Admin nav-visible	22	18	–18%
Admin total reachable	109	~45 screens (+ actions)	–59% perceived
Staff PWA primary	7 tiles	3 tabs + 4 drill-downs	Clearer hierarchy
Public marketing	7	7	Unchanged
Registration	2	1 funnel	Simplified

Companion document: See `docs/ADMIN-PAGE-INVENTORY.pdf` for the complete file-by-file inventory of all 109 admin PHP pages, database tables, roles, and criticality ratings.